

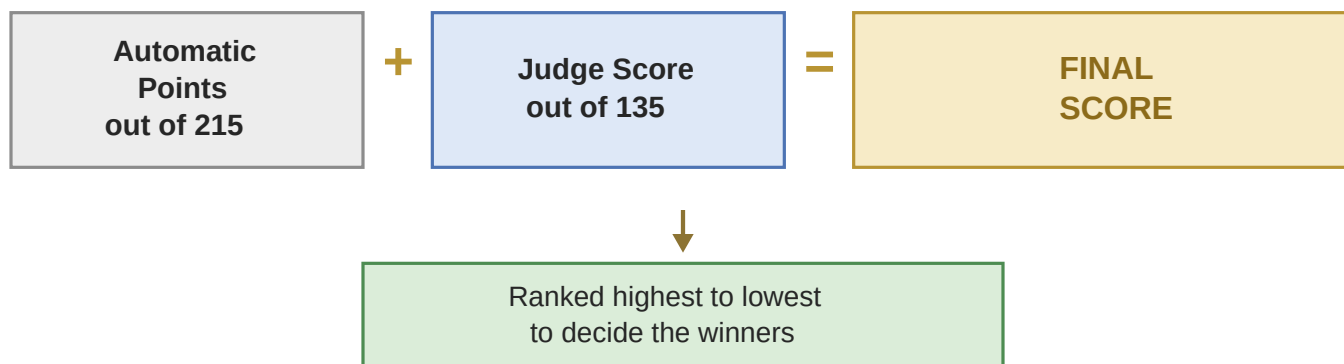
How Scoring Works

Leave It Better Than You Found It - Student Competition

This is a plain-language guide to how a student's final score is decided. No technical knowledge needed. Read it top to bottom - each part builds on the one before.

The Big Picture

Every student ends up with one FINAL SCORE. That score is made of two parts added together:



In one line: Automatic Points (215) + Judge Score (135) = Final Score, then everyone is ranked.

Part 1 - Automatic Points (out of 215)

These points are earned AUTOMATICALLY by the computer as the student completes each step of the program. Nobody grades these by hand - finishing the work simply adds the points.

A student earns automatic points for things like:

- Registering and getting approved (by the school, teacher and parent).
- Completing each of the 10 local-business interviews.
- Uploading supporting materials (business card, photos, website screenshot, flyer, etc.).
- Submitting the project video and the written report.
- Extra credit for the AI demonstration and community-service activity.

Think of Automatic Points as a reward for DOING all the work. The more of the program the student finishes, the higher this number climbs - up to 215.

Part 2 - Judge Score (out of 135)

This is the human part. Judges read the student's finished PROJECT and rate its QUALITY. They are scoring the project as a whole - not each interview separately.

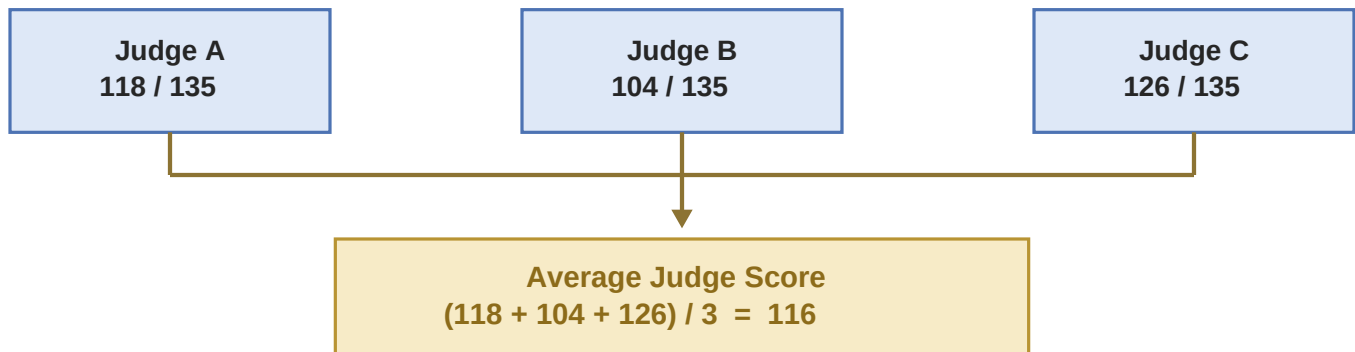
Every judge rates the same 6 things. Each has its own maximum:

Problem - how clearly the real problem is identified	20 pts
Solution - how good and workable the idea is	50 pts
Creativity - how original and fresh the thinking is	20 pts
Supporting Evidence - photos, interviews, documents	10 pts
Community Impact - how much it helps the community	20 pts
Presentation - how clear the video & report are	15 pts
TOTAL a single judge can give	135

Each judge adds up their 6 numbers to get a score out of 135 for that project.

When There Are Several Judges

Usually MORE THAN ONE judge scores the same project. To be fair, we do not pick one judge - we take the AVERAGE of all the judges' scores.



So no single judge decides the outcome. One judge being a little strict or a little generous evens out across the average.

Putting It All Together - An Example

Imagine a student named Aarav:

- Automatic Points (from completing the whole program): 175 out of 215.
- Average Judge Score (from the judges above): 116 out of 135.
- FINAL SCORE = $175 + 116 = 291$.

Every student gets a final score this way, and the highest final scores win. If two students tie, we compare their judge category scores in this order: Solution, then Community, then Creativity, then Problem, then Presentation.

Fairness Rules

- Judges CANNOT see the automatic points - so those never sway their opinion of the project.
- Judges CANNOT see each other's scores - so they are not influenced by one another.
- If a judge personally knows a student or business, they "Recuse" (step aside) and do not score that project.
- Only the administrator can see everything: each judge's score, the average, the automatic points, and the final ranking.

Quick Summary

1. Students earn Automatic Points (max 215) by doing the work.
2. Judges rate the project quality on 6 things (max 135 each judge).
3. Several judges' scores are averaged for fairness.
4. Final Score = Automatic Points + Average Judge Score.
5. Students are ranked by final score to decide the winners.